

1787 · 1796 · 1920 • UNITED STATES GOVERNMENT & CIVICS (GC) • COURSE
STANDARD EDITION

GOVERNMENT HACK™

TROOPTOTEACHER TECHNOLOGIES

UNIT 2

Citizen Participation

COURSE STANDARD EDITION

GC.31–GC.34 • Tennessee U.S. Government & Civics Standards • Grades 9–12

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

Tennessee cast the deciding vote for women's suffrage. In August 1920 it became the 36th and final state needed to ratify the 19th Amendment — the 'Perfect 36' — when 24-year-old legislator Harry Burn changed his vote after a note from his mother, extending the vote to women nationwide (GC.34, GC.31).

One common workbook designed for learner variability. Every student works toward the same Tennessee standards; supports vary the means, not the goal or the ceiling.

Release-Ready · Pilot Edition

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Government Hack™ — Unit 2: Citizen Participation, Course Standard Edition.

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Source integrity. Every primary source in this unit is public-domain and cited to its holding repository (National Archives, Library of Congress). See the Source Library.

Reading provenance (district-clear). Close-Read passages are labeled “Government Hack-authored instructional synthesis” — they build on the standard record and are not presented as primary sources.

Framework stack. This workbook anchors to Tennessee U.S. Government & Civics standards GC.31–GC.34 and the Social Studies Practices (SSP.01–SSP.06), and is designed on CAST UDL 3.0 and an MTSS support model.

Pacing. Each standard is built for **one 45-minute class period**. Each activity shows a  ~ **minutes** estimate at its heading. There is more here than one period holds — your teacher chooses which activities you do in class; the rest may become warm-ups, stations, or homework.

Table of Contents

Tennessee Standards & SSP Crosswalk

Each standard below is taught to the full Course Standard expectation; the Social Studies Practices are embedded in every activity cycle.

Standard	Focus	Student Deck slides
GC.31	The Responsibilities of Citizens	2-8
GC.32	Political Parties & the Nomination Process	2-8
GC.33	The Media & Public Opinion	2-8
GC.34	Means of Political Participation	2-8

Social Studies Practices (SSP.01-SSP.06)

SSP.01 Gather/evaluate sources · SSP.02 Critically examine a primary source · SSP.03 Synthesize evidence · SSP.04 Construct/communicate argument · SSP.05 Develop historical awareness · SSP.06 Chronological/spatial reasoning. Each Close Read, Primary Source/Data, and CER activity names the practices it builds.

Accessibility, UDL & Accommodations Matrix

One firm learning goal per standard; flexible, universal means. Supports are available by design and never lower the goal. They work alongside — never in place of — required IEP or 504 accommodations.

Universal support	What it is	Where it appears
CORE PATH	Essential instruction every student completes	Every activity
LANGUAGE SUPPORT	Vocabulary, pronunciation, Spanish cognates	Word Bank, Guided/Light Backs
RESPONSE CHOICE	Write, say/record, or diagram	Every activity
SUPPORT OPTION	Optional scaffold that keeps the goal	Guided Support Back, Primary Source
PROGRESS CHECK	Quick DOK-2/3 check to guide reteach/extend	Cornell Notes, Practice Quiz
EXTENSION	Deeper challenge once the goal is met	Extension Bank, CER

How CAST UDL 3.0 is visible in this workbook

Multiple means of Engagement (response choice, relevance via Tennessee Connection), Representation (Word Bank, pronunciation, Spanish, Close-Read supports), and Action & Expression (write/say/diagram, Frayer, CER). No fixed-track labels appear.

My Support Plan (optional — you choose)

Supports are available by design. Check the ones you might try; you can change your mind any time.

Support I might use	When it would help me
Word Bank + Spanish column	
Guided or Light Support Back	
Response choice (say/record or diagram)	
Sentence frames / Rehearsal Lab	

How to Use This Workbook

Each standard runs the same seven-activity cycle: (1) Vocabulary Word Bank, (2) Vocabulary Studio, (3) Direct-Teaching Cornell Notes with optional Guided and Light Support Backs, (4) Close Read, (5) Primary Source / Data Analysis, (6) Core Application Practice Quiz, (7) Constructed Response (CER). Work the CORE PATH; reach for SUPPORT OPTIONS as needed.

Label legend — these appear throughout every standard cycle

Label	Meaning
CORE PATH	The essential instruction every student completes.
SUPPORT OPTION	An optional scaffold that keeps the goal, not lowers it.
LANGUAGE SUPPORT	Vocabulary, pronunciation, and Spanish cognates for access.
RESPONSE CHOICE	Show learning by writing, saying/recording, or diagramming.
PROGRESS CHECK	A quick DOK-2/3 check that guides reteach or extend.
EXTENSION	A deeper challenge once the goal is met.

Before You Begin — Set a S.M.A.R.T. Goal

Strong learners set goals — but a goal only helps if it is built well. First learn how, then write yours.

WHAT MAKES A GOAL STRONG? Build it S.M.A.R.T.

S — Specific: say exactly what you will be able to do (“explain how a bill becomes law,” not “do well”).

M — Measurable: how will you PROVE it? — a score, a diagram, or teaching a partner.

A — Achievable: a real stretch you can reach with effort — not too easy, not impossible.

R — Relevant: it connects to this unit’s big question.

T — Time-bound: name WHEN — “by the end of this unit.”

SEE THE DIFFERENCE

Weak: “I want to do good in government.” (vague — nothing to measure)

S.M.A.R.T.: “By the end of this unit I can explain how the three branches check each other, and prove it by teaching a partner and scoring 80%+ on the check.”

This unit’s big question: How do citizens shape their government — and what does it ask of them in return?

BUILD YOURS — write each piece on the lines, then combine them at the bottom

Fill in each part of your goal. Use the lines.

Part of my goal	Write your piece on the lines
S — Specific: what exactly will I be able to do?	_____ _____
M — Measurable: how will I prove it? (a score, a diagram, teaching a partner)	_____ _____
A — Achievable: what effort will it take to reach it?	_____ _____
R — Relevant: how does it connect to the big question above?	_____ _____
T — Time-bound: by when?	_____ _____

PUT IT TOGETHER — my S.M.A.R.T. goal in one or two sentences:

Standard GC.31 — The Responsibilities of Citizens

TN Academic Standard GC.31: Describe what should be reasonably expected from any citizen or resident of the U.S., and explain why it is important for the well-being of the nation, including: being informed on civic issues; obeying the law; paying taxes; respecting the rights of others; serving as a juror; serving in the military or alternative service; volunteering and performing public service; voting. (C, T)

LEARNING TARGETS — I can...

- I can describe what should reasonably be expected from any citizen or resident of the U.S. and explain why those responsibilities matter..

Lenses for this standard: Culture (C) · Tennessee (T)

CORE PATH — the same for every student

Every student works this standard at the same rigor: analyze the sources and vocabulary, then show what you learned on the Practice Quiz and the CER. Check yourself against the learning targets on the Cornell Notes page. Supports for each step are on the back of this page.

SET YOUR GOAL (self-direction)

My goal for this standard — what will I be able to do, and how will I show it? (Need help? See the back of this page.)

HOOK — think before you dig in

Some duties can land you in court if you skip them; others no one can force you to do — yet the republic needs both. Which is which?

ACTIVATE — what do you already know or wonder?

Jot what you already know or want to find out about this standard. You'll come back to it.

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — before you dig in (you'll revisit this at the end)

In your own words: what do you think this standard is about, and why might it matter to you or your community? Write 2-3 sentences.

Getting Started — supports for this page — GC.31

WHAT “CORE PATH” MEANS

Everyone learns the same standard at the same level. “Support options” are just extra ways in — sentence starters, an example, a partner, or recording your answer. They help you reach the bar; they never lower it.

SET YOUR GOAL — how to write a strong one

Example goal: “By the end of this standard I can explain ___ and prove it by scoring 80%+ on the quiz.”

How to build it: name what you’ll DO, then how you’ll PROVE it, then WHEN.

Sentence starters: “I want to be able to...” “I’ll show it by...” “By the end of this standard...”

HOOK — sentence starters

“I think the big question is...” “This connects to...” “I wonder why...” “At first I believe...”

ACTIVATE — what it means & how to answer

What it means: “Activate” = wake up what you ALREADY know before you learn more.

Sentence starters: “I already know...” “This reminds me of...” “I want to find out...”

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — what to write

Just your honest first take — there is no wrong answer. Say what you THINK the standard is about and why it might matter to you, your family, or your community. You’ll come back and improve it at the end.

KEY WORDS TO WATCH FOR

Civic Responsibility · Jury Duty · Naturalization

NOW TRY IT — draft your goal using a starter above

Write a first draft here, then copy your best version onto the front. Aim for: what you’ll DO + how you’ll PROVE it + WHEN.

Activity 1 — Vocabulary (Part A: Reference / Word Bank) — GC.31 ~10 min

Use this word bank throughout the standard. The Spanish column supports access, not translation of assessment.

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Civic Responsibility	A duty a citizen is expected to fulfill for the good of the community and nation — such as voting, obeying the law, paying taxes, and serving on a jury.	responsabilidad cívica
Jury Duty	The responsibility to serve on a jury when called, deciding facts in a trial — a citizen's direct role in the justice system guaranteed by the 6th and 7th Amendments.	deber de jurado
Naturalization	The legal process by which a foreign-born person becomes a U.S. citizen, gaining the rights and taking on the responsibilities of citizenship.	naturalización

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Pronunciations: Civic Responsibility (SIV-ik ree-spon-suh-BIL-ih-tee); Jury Duty (JOOR-ee DOO-tee); Naturalization (natch-er-uh-lih-ZAY-shun).

VOCABULARY SELF-CHECK · Knowledge Rating

Rate each term NOW in pencil, then again at the END — growth is the goal; no penalty for “never seen it.”

Term	1 · never seen it	2 · heard it	3 · can use it	4 · can teach it
Civic Responsibility	_____	_____	_____	_____
Jury Duty	_____	_____	_____	_____
Naturalization	_____	_____	_____	_____

MAKE IT YOURS (RESPONSE CHOICE): choose ONE term above and show you own it — write a sentence, sketch it, or give a real-world example.

QUICK WRITE

Which of these terms do you think will matter MOST for this standard, and why? You'll revisit this at the end.

Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer-inspired) — GC.31

~7 min

RESPONSE CHOICE — three ways to complete each studio**WRITE:** fill in the four boxes below in your own words.**SAY IT:** explain the term aloud to a partner or your teacher, or record a short voice note — say the term, its meaning, and one example.**DIAGRAM:** sketch or map the term in the Sketch Studio on the back of this page.**PRIORITY TERM 1 Civic Responsibility** · ES: responsabilidad cívica**Word-bank meaning to build on:** A duty a citizen is expected to fulfill for the good of the community and nation — such as voting, obeying the law, paying taxes, and serving on a jury.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Civic Responsibility” to explain this standard.

PRIORITY TERM 2 Jury Duty · ES: deber de jurado**Word-bank meaning to build on:** The responsibility to serve on a jury when called, deciding facts in a trial — a citizen's direct role in the justice system guaranteed by the 6th and 7th Amendments.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Jury Duty” to explain this standard.

CONNECT THE TERMS (UDL · build understanding)

How do these priority terms fit together? Write how one leads to or affects another on the lines — or map it in the Sketch Studio on the back.

Activity 2 — Sketch Studio (draw it or say it) — GC.31

SAY IT — pick one way to explain your terms aloud

Explain each priority term to a shoulder partner, then have them explain one back to you.

Or explain a term to your teacher during check-in.

Or record a 20–30 second voice note: say the term, what it means, and one real example.

Or stand and share one term with the class.

DIAGRAM: Civic Responsibility

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

DIAGRAM: Jury Duty

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

CONNECT THE TERMS — concept map

Put both terms in the box and draw arrows to show how one leads to, needs, or affects the other. Write a few words on each arrow.

Activity 3 — Direct Teaching Cornell Notes — GC.31 ⌚ ~20 min

GC.31 — The Responsibilities of Citizens • Lean Student Deck slides 2–8 • direct-teaching slides 4–6

Your learning targets are on this standard’s opening page — take notes that help you meet them.

Guiding cues	My notes — write your notes here
Key idea of this standard?	
One source that supports it?	
One effect on participation or government?	
Key terms →	

DOODLE ZONE — draw your thinking (UDL · another way in)
Need another way in? Sketch the key idea, a quick timeline, or how the pieces connect. Words optional.

Cornell Notes — keep going, then process & check — GC.31

UDL · CHOOSE HOW YOU CAPTURE IDEAS (same target for everyone)

Keep going with your notes: WRITE on the lines, DRAW or diagram in the box, or do both — your choice. You may also record your notes aloud.

DRAW / DIAGRAM — sketch the idea, a timeline, or how the pieces connect

WRITE — keep taking notes on the lines

Key terms to list

Civic Responsibility · Jury Duty · Naturalization

Summary — In your own words (2-3 sentences)

PROGRESS CHECK · one question

Why does Jefferson argue that citizens must be 'well informed'?

- A. So that only experts are allowed to vote
- B. Because informed citizens can be trusted to govern themselves and correct problems
- C. So the government can raise taxes more easily
- D. Because the Constitution requires a literacy test to vote

Commit before you move on — mark it, say it, or explain it aloud.

CHECK YOURSELF — how am I doing?

Which learning targets (on this standard's opening page) can you now meet? Tick the number; circle any you still need help with.

☐ **1**

My 12-15 word headline for this standard

Guided Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.31

These scaffolds support ONLY the Cornell notes — use them to take and process those notes. Optional and easy to set aside; not a separate assignment or a label.

Key vocabulary	What it means
Civic Responsibility	A duty a citizen is expected to fulfill for the good of the community and nation — such as voting, obeying the law, paying taxes, and serving on a jury.
Jury Duty	The responsibility to serve on a jury when called, deciding facts in a trial — a citizen's direct role in the justice system guaranteed by the 6th and 7th Amendments.
Naturalization	The legal process by which a foreign-born person becomes a U.S. citizen, gaining the rights and taking on the responsibilities of citizenship.

Break it into steps:

1) Name one cause or effect. 2) Give one piece of evidence. 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of the responsibilities of citizens was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of the responsibilities of citizens was Civic Responsibility: A duty a citizen is expected to fulfill for the good of the community and nation — such as voting, obeying the law, paying taxes, and serving on a jury.

GUIDED NOTE REHEARSAL LAB — practice ONE note, step by step

Build one good note here first, then copy it onto your Cornell page. Name the idea → give one piece of evidence → explain the link → write a short headline.

Step	Rehearse it here
Name it	_____ _____
Evidence	_____ _____
Explain	_____ _____
Headline	_____ _____

TRANSFER CHECK — move one rehearsed idea onto the front notes

Light Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.31

A lighter scaffold for the SAME Cornell notes. Try the notes first; reach for this only if you need it.

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Civic Responsibility	
Jury Duty	
Naturalization	

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below (or in your front notes):

- According to Jefferson, what makes it safe to trust the people with their own government?
- Which responsibilities in this standard are legal duties, and which are expected of good citizens but not legally required?
- The 6th Amendment guarantees a jury — how does that make jury duty a responsibility, not just a right?

WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?

Circle the Cornell cue from the front page you still need help with, and tell your teacher so we can go over it.

LIGHT PROCESSING LAB

Answer one guiding question from above in a full sentence, in your own words.

Activity 4 — Close Read — GC.31 ~15 min

Reading type: Government Hack-authored instructional synthesis. This is not a primary source. Builds SSP.03 (synthesize) and SSP.05 (historical awareness).

CORE PATH

Citizenship comes with rights — and with responsibilities that keep a republic working. Some are legal duties everyone must meet: obeying the law, paying taxes, and serving on a jury when called. Others are expected of good citizens even though no one is arrested for skipping them: staying informed on civic issues, respecting the rights of others, volunteering, and voting. Thomas Jefferson argued that self-government only works when the people are 'well informed.' Naturalized citizens take on the same responsibilities as those born here, promising in the Oath of Allegiance to support the Constitution and serve the nation. A republic asks little of any one citizen — but it depends on most citizens doing their part.

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Key terms to know first: Civic Responsibility, Jury Duty. Read once for the gist, then again for evidence.

Text-dependent questions (answer in the Evidence Lab below or aloud):

1. According to Jefferson, what makes it safe to trust the people with their own government?
2. Which responsibilities in this standard are legal duties, and which are expected of good citizens but not legally required?
3. The 6th Amendment guarantees a jury — how does that make jury duty a responsibility, not just a right?

RESPONSE CHOICE: answer any question by writing in the Evidence Lab, saying/recording it, or diagramming it.

CLOSE-READ EVIDENCE LAB

Log evidence from the passage below.

Question / claim	Exact passage evidence	What the evidence shows

In one sentence — the main idea of this reading:

Spaced Retrieval & Reflection — GC.31

SPACED RETRIEVAL — quick recall (no notes)

Pull it up cold to strengthen memory, then check your notes — retrieval is what makes learning stick.

Recall prompt	Your answer (from memory)
One key term or fact from THIS standard	
One thing you learned in an EARLIER standard — how does it connect?	
One question you can answer now that you could not before	

CHECK YOURSELF — look back and score how it went

Got it right? ☐ Yes ☐ Partly ☐ Not yet **Answer it from memory?** ☐ Yes ☐ With a hint ☐ No

How did it feel? ☐ Confident ☐ Getting there ☐ Shaky — I'll revisit

CONNECT IT — spiral back

How does this standard connect to one you studied earlier, or to something in the world today? Write 2-3 sentences.

WHERE AM I? — plan your next step

Rate your understanding of this standard (1-4): ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

One thing I will review or ask about before the quiz:

Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data Analysis — GC.31 ⌚ ~15 min

Primary source (cartoon) — analyze it with HIPPO. Builds SSP.01-SSP.02.



I Want YOU for U.S. Army (Uncle Sam) • James Montgomery Flagg • 1917

Source: Library of Congress • <https://www.loc.gov/item/96507165/> Public domain — no known restrictions; no copyright renewal <https://www.loc.gov/item/96507165/>

FIRST LOOK — before you analyze
Jot 3-4 things you notice in the source (details, words, people, dates). No wrong answers.

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
H — Historical context: what was happening when this was created?	
I — Intended audience: who was meant to see or obey it?	
P — Purpose: why was it created?	
P — Point of view: whose perspective does it reflect?	

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
O — Outside connection: how does it connect to this standard?	

Primary Source Analysis — go deeper — GC.31

SUPPORT OPTION (use if you need it)

Sentence frame: This source shows _____ because it _____, which reveals _____.

SOURCE SYNTHESIS — put it together (SSP.03)

In 2–3 sentences: what does this source reveal about this standard, and how do you know? Cite one specific detail from it.

THINK LIKE A HISTORIAN — corroborate or challenge (SSP.03)

Name ONE other source that could CONFIRM this one, and ONE way it could COMPLICATE or CHALLENGE it — or, whose voice is missing here?

SO WHAT? — why this source still matters today

In 1–2 sentences: why does this source still matter for understanding government today?

CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN

Rate your understanding of this standard (1–4): _____ One thing to revisit:

Activity 6 — Core Application: Practice Quiz — GC.31 ~8 min**RESPONSE CHOICE**

Commit to an answer by marking it, saying it, or explaining it aloud before checking. Answer key is in the Teacher Guide (kept separate).

[DOK 1 • item u2-gc31-dok1-1 • pre-field-test]

Which of the following is a LEGAL responsibility of U.S. citizens?

- A. Volunteering at a food bank
- B. Serving on a jury when summoned
- C. Following political news
- D. Attending a campaign rally

[DOK 2 • item u1-gc31-dok2-tc • pre-field-test]

Why does Jefferson argue that citizens must be 'well informed'?

- A. So that only experts are allowed to vote
- B. Because informed citizens can be trusted to govern themselves and correct problems
- C. So the government can raise taxes more easily
- D. Because the Constitution requires a literacy test to vote

STRETCH — think like a test-writer (open to all)

Write your OWN DOK-3 question for this standard, then a one-sentence answer key. Use the supports below — everyone can do this.

HOW TO WRITE A DOK-3 QUESTION (supports)

DOK-3 = strategic thinking: the reader must analyze, compare, evaluate, or justify using evidence — and there should be more than one defensible answer (not a fact you can just look up).

Sentence starters: “Why did _____ lead to _____?” • “Which mattered more — _____ or _____ — and why?” • “What is the BEST evidence that _____?” • “Evaluate whether _____.” • “Defend or challenge: _____.”

Frame: [Analyze / Evaluate / Justify] + [something from THIS standard] + “using evidence.”

Quick check: does my question make the reader THINK and use evidence? If yes, it's DOK-3.

NOW WRITE YOUR DOK-3 QUESTION HERE

YOUR ANSWER KEY — one clear, defensible sentence

Activity 7 — Constructed Response (CER) — GC.31 ⌚ ~15 min**BIG-QUESTION ORGANIZER (before you write) — How do citizens shape their government — and what does it ask of them in return?**

Plan your argument here, then use it to write your claim, evidence, and reasoning below.

Plan your argument	Your quick notes (from this standard)
My claim (answer the prompt)	
Evidence 1 (a source or fact)	
Reasoning (why it proves the claim)	

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (CER) — builds SSP.04 Argumentation

Claim + Evidence + Reasoning: Which citizen responsibility matters most for the well-being of the nation — voting, staying informed, or jury service? Defend your claim with evidence from a source.

Part	Write here
Claim	
Evidence (two specifics)	
Reasoning	

Constructed Response — self-grade & supports — GC.31

SELF-GRADE — score your own CER against the rubric below

Reread your response, then circle the level that best fits each part. Being honest here is how you level up.

Level	Claim	Evidence	Reasoning
4 — Strong	Precise, defensible	2+ accurate, specific	Explains HOW evidence proves the claim
3 — Proficient	Clear	2 accurate	Explains the link
2 — Developing	General	1 accurate	Partial link
1 — Beginning	Unclear / missing	Missing / inaccurate	No reasoning

MY SCORE

Claim: ____ / 4 Evidence: ____ / 4 Reasoning: ____ / 4 TOTAL: ____ / 12

SUPPORTS — sentence frames (use if you need them)

Claim: “_____ because _____.”

Evidence: “One example is _____ (from _____). Another is _____.”

Reasoning: “This proves my claim because _____, which shows _____.”

REVISE — make your lowest-scoring part stronger

Pick the part you scored lowest and rewrite it here — better:

Standard GC.32 — Political Parties & the Nomination Process

TN Academic Standard GC.32: Explain the role of political parties in the nomination process for presidential candidates and the importance of and difference between primaries, caucuses, and general elections. (T)

LEARNING TARGETS — I can...

- I can explain the role of political parties in nominating presidential candidates and the difference between primaries, caucuses, and general elections..

Lenses for this standard: Tennessee (T)

CORE PATH — the same for every student

Every student works this standard at the same rigor: analyze the sources and vocabulary, then show what you learned on the Practice Quiz and the CER. Check yourself against the learning targets on the Cornell Notes page. Supports for each step are on the back of this page.

SET YOUR GOAL (self-direction)

My goal for this standard — what will I be able to do, and how will I show it? (Need help? See the back of this page.)

HOOK — think before you dig in

The Constitution never mentions political parties — and the first president warned against them. So why does every election run through them?

ACTIVATE — what do you already know or wonder?

Jot what you already know or want to find out about this standard. You'll come back to it.

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — before you dig in (you'll revisit this at the end)

In your own words: what do you think this standard is about, and why might it matter to you or your community? Write 2-3 sentences.

Getting Started — supports for this page — GC.32

WHAT “CORE PATH” MEANS

Everyone learns the same standard at the same level. “Support options” are just extra ways in — sentence starters, an example, a partner, or recording your answer. They help you reach the bar; they never lower it.

SET YOUR GOAL — how to write a strong one

Example goal: “By the end of this standard I can explain ___ and prove it by scoring 80%+ on the quiz.”

How to build it: name what you’ll DO, then how you’ll PROVE it, then WHEN.

Sentence starters: “I want to be able to...” “I’ll show it by...” “By the end of this standard...”

HOOK — sentence starters

“I think the big question is...” “This connects to...” “I wonder why...” “At first I believe...”

ACTIVATE — what it means & how to answer

What it means: “Activate” = wake up what you ALREADY know before you learn more.

Sentence starters: “I already know...” “This reminds me of...” “I want to find out...”

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — what to write

Just your honest first take — there is no wrong answer. Say what you THINK the standard is about and why it might matter to you, your family, or your community. You’ll come back and improve it at the end.

KEY WORDS TO WATCH FOR

Political Party · Primary Election · Caucus

NOW TRY IT — draft your goal using a starter above

Write a first draft here, then copy your best version onto the front. Aim for: what you’ll DO + how you’ll PROVE it + WHEN.

Activity 1 — Vocabulary (Part A: Reference / Word Bank) — GC.32 ~10 min

Use this word bank throughout the standard. The Spanish column supports access, not translation of assessment.

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Political Party	An organized group that seeks to win elections and control government by nominating candidates and uniting voters around shared ideas.	partido político
Primary Election	An election in which party members vote to choose their party's candidate for the general election; an 'open' primary lets any voter participate, a 'closed' one only registered party members.	elección primaria
Caucus	A local meeting where party members discuss and select their preferred candidate through debate and voting, rather than a secret ballot.	caucus / asamblea partidaria

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Pronunciations: Political Party (puh-LIT-ih-kul PAR-tee); Primary Election (PRY-mair-ee ee-LEK-shun); Caucus (KAW-kus).

VOCABULARY SELF-CHECK · Knowledge Rating

Rate each term NOW in pencil, then again at the END — growth is the goal; no penalty for “never seen it.”

Term	1 · never seen it	2 · heard it	3 · can use it	4 · can teach it
Political Party	_____	_____	_____	_____
Primary Election	_____	_____	_____	_____
Caucus	_____	_____	_____	_____

MAKE IT YOURS (RESPONSE CHOICE): choose ONE term above and show you own it — write a sentence, sketch it, or give a real-world example.

QUICK WRITE

Which of these terms do you think will matter MOST for this standard, and why? You'll revisit this at the end.

Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer-inspired) — GC.32

~7 min

RESPONSE CHOICE — three ways to complete each studio**WRITE:** fill in the four boxes below in your own words.**SAY IT:** explain the term aloud to a partner or your teacher, or record a short voice note — say the term, its meaning, and one example.**DIAGRAM:** sketch or map the term in the Sketch Studio on the back of this page.**PRIORITY TERM 1 Primary Election** · ES: elección primaria**Word-bank meaning to build on:** An election in which party members vote to choose their party's candidate for the general election; an 'open' primary lets any voter participate, a 'closed' one only registered party members.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Primary Election” to explain this standard.

PRIORITY TERM 2 Caucus · ES: caucus / asamblea partidaria**Word-bank meaning to build on:** A local meeting where party members discuss and select their preferred candidate through debate and voting, rather than a secret ballot.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Caucus” to explain this standard.

CONNECT THE TERMS (UDL · build understanding)

How do these priority terms fit together? Write how one leads to or affects another on the lines — or map it in the Sketch Studio on the back.

Activity 2 — Sketch Studio (draw it or say it) — GC.32

SAY IT — pick one way to explain your terms aloud

Explain each priority term to a shoulder partner, then have them explain one back to you.

Or explain a term to your teacher during check-in.

Or record a 20–30 second voice note: say the term, what it means, and one real example.

Or stand and share one term with the class.

DIAGRAM: Primary Election

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

DIAGRAM: Caucus

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

CONNECT THE TERMS — concept map

Put both terms in the box and draw arrows to show how one leads to, needs, or affects the other. Write a few words on each arrow.

Activity 3 — Direct Teaching Cornell Notes — GC.32 ⌚ ~20 min

GC.32 — Political Parties & the Nomination Process • Lean Student Deck slides 2–8 • direct-teaching slides 4–6

Your learning targets are on this standard’s opening page — take notes that help you meet them.

Guiding cues	My notes — write your notes here
Key idea of this standard?	
One source that supports it?	
One effect on participation or government?	
Key terms →	

DOODLE ZONE — draw your thinking (UDL · another way in)
Need another way in? Sketch the key idea, a quick timeline, or how the pieces connect. Words optional.

Cornell Notes — keep going, then process & check — GC.32

UDL · CHOOSE HOW YOU CAPTURE IDEAS (same target for everyone)

Keep going with your notes: WRITE on the lines, DRAW or diagram in the box, or do both — your choice. You may also record your notes aloud.

DRAW / DIAGRAM — sketch the idea, a timeline, or how the pieces connect

WRITE — keep taking notes on the lines

Key terms to list

Political Party · Primary Election · Caucus

Summary — In your own words (2-3 sentences)

PROGRESS CHECK · one question

What is the main difference between a primary and a caucus?

- A. A primary chooses a president; a caucus chooses a governor
- B. A primary is only held in general elections; a caucus is only for judges
- C. A primary uses a ballot vote; a caucus selects candidates through local meetings and discussion
- D. A primary is run by the government; a caucus is illegal in most states

Commit before you move on — mark it, say it, or explain it aloud.

CHECK YOURSELF — how am I doing?

Which learning targets (on this standard's opening page) can you now meet? Tick the number; circle any you still need help with.

☐ **1**

My 12-15 word headline for this standard

Guided Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.32

These scaffolds support ONLY the Cornell notes — use them to take and process those notes. Optional and easy to set aside; not a separate assignment or a label.

Key vocabulary	What it means
Political Party	An organized group that seeks to win elections and control government by nominating candidates and uniting voters around shared ideas.
Primary Election	An election in which party members vote to choose their party's candidate for the general election; an 'open' primary lets any voter participate, a 'closed' one only registered party members.
Caucus	A local meeting where party members discuss and select their preferred candidate through debate and voting, rather than a secret ballot.

Break it into steps:

1) Name one cause or effect. 2) Give one piece of evidence. 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of political parties & the nomination process was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of political parties & the nomination process was Political Party: An organized group that seeks to win elections and control government by nominating candidates and uniting voters around shared ideas.

GUIDED NOTE REHEARSAL LAB — practice ONE note, step by step

Build one good note here first, then copy it onto your Cornell page. Name the idea → give one piece of evidence → explain the link → write a short headline.

Step	Rehearse it here
Name it	_____ _____
Evidence	_____ _____
Explain	_____ _____
Headline	_____ _____

TRANSFER CHECK — move one rehearsed idea onto the front notes

Light Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.32

A lighter scaffold for the SAME Cornell notes. Try the notes first; reach for this only if you need it.

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Political Party	
Primary Election	
Caucus	

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below (or in your front notes):

- What did Washington fear about the 'spirit of party,' and did his warning come true?
- How does Madison define a 'faction,' and how is a modern political party similar to and different from it?
- Trace a candidate's path: primary/caucus → convention → general election. What happens at each step?

WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?

Circle the Cornell cue from the front page you still need help with, and tell your teacher so we can go over it.

LIGHT PROCESSING LAB

Answer one guiding question from above in a full sentence, in your own words.

Activity 4 — Close Read — GC.32 ~15 min

Reading type: Government Hack-authored instructional synthesis. This is not a primary source. Builds SSP.03 (synthesize) and SSP.05 (historical awareness).

CORE PATH

The Constitution never mentions political parties — and George Washington warned against 'the spirit of party.' Yet parties formed almost immediately and now organize how Americans participate. To reach the general election, a candidate must first win the party's nomination. Parties choose nominees two main ways: primaries, where members cast ballots (open primaries allow any voter; closed primaries only party members), and caucuses, where members gather in local meetings to debate and select a candidate. These contests, held state by state, build toward each party's national convention, where the nominee is made official. In the general election, voters then choose among the parties' nominees. The two-party system that resulted shapes nearly every election in the United States.

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Key terms to know first: Political Party, Primary Election. Read once for the gist, then again for evidence.

Text-dependent questions (answer in the Evidence Lab below or aloud):

1. What did Washington fear about the 'spirit of party,' and did his warning come true?
2. How does Madison define a 'faction,' and how is a modern political party similar to and different from it?
3. Trace a candidate's path: primary/caucus → convention → general election. What happens at each step?

RESPONSE CHOICE: answer any question by writing in the Evidence Lab, saying/recording it, or diagramming it.

CLOSE-READ EVIDENCE LAB

Log evidence from the passage below.

Question / claim	Exact passage evidence	What the evidence shows

In one sentence — the main idea of this reading:

Spaced Retrieval & Reflection — GC.32

SPACED RETRIEVAL — quick recall (no notes)

Pull it up cold to strengthen memory, then check your notes — retrieval is what makes learning stick.

Recall prompt

Your answer (from memory)

One key term or fact from THIS standard

One thing you learned in an EARLIER standard — how does it connect?

One question you can answer now that you could not before

CHECK YOURSELF — look back and score how it went

Got it right? ☐ Yes ☐ Partly ☐ Not yet **Answer it from memory?** ☐ Yes ☐ With a hint ☐ No

How did it feel? ☐ Confident ☐ Getting there ☐ Shaky — I'll revisit

CONNECT IT — spiral back

How does this standard connect to one you studied earlier, or to something in the world today? Write 2-3 sentences.

WHERE AM I? — plan your next step

Rate your understanding of this standard (1-4): ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

One thing I will review or ask about before the quiz:

Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data Analysis — GC.32 ~15 min

Document (text primary source — analyze with HIPPO). Builds SSP.01–SSP.02.

FAREWELL ADDRESS

“Let me now... warn you in the most solemn manner against the baneful effects of the spirit of party generally.”

Source: George Washington, 1796. The Avalon Project, Yale Law School. Public domain.
https://avalon.law.yale.edu/18th_century/washing.asp

FIRST LOOK — before you analyze

Jot 3–4 things you notice in the source (details, words, people, dates). No wrong answers.

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
H — Historical context: what was happening when this was created?	
I — Intended audience: who was meant to see or obey it?	
P — Purpose: why was it created?	
P — Point of view: whose perspective does it reflect?	
O — Outside connection: how does it connect to this standard?	

Primary Source Analysis — go deeper — GC.32

SUPPORT OPTION (use if you need it)

Sentence frame: This source shows _____ because it _____, which reveals _____.

SOURCE SYNTHESIS — put it together (SSP.03)

In 2–3 sentences: what does this source reveal about this standard, and how do you know? Cite one specific detail from it.

THINK LIKE A HISTORIAN — corroborate or challenge (SSP.03)

Name ONE other source that could CONFIRM this one, and ONE way it could COMPLICATE or CHALLENGE it — or, whose voice is missing here?

SO WHAT? — why this source still matters today

In 1–2 sentences: why does this source still matter for understanding government today?

CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN

Rate your understanding of this standard (1–4): _____ One thing to revisit:

Activity 6 — Core Application: Practice Quiz — GC.32 ⌚ ~8 min**RESPONSE CHOICE**

Commit to an answer by marking it, saying it, or explaining it aloud before checking. Answer key is in the Teacher Guide (kept separate).

[DOK 1 • item u2-gc32-dok1-1 • pre-field-test]

In a closed primary, who is allowed to vote?

- A. Any registered voter
- B. Only registered members of that party
- C. Only elected officials
- D. Only voters over age 35

[DOK 2 • item u1-gc32-dok2-tc • pre-field-test]

What is the main difference between a primary and a caucus?

- A. A primary chooses a president; a caucus chooses a governor
- B. A primary is only held in general elections; a caucus is only for judges
- C. A primary uses a ballot vote; a caucus selects candidates through local meetings and discussion
- D. A primary is run by the government; a caucus is illegal in most states

STRETCH — think like a test-writer (open to all)

Write your OWN DOK-3 question for this standard, then a one-sentence answer key. Use the supports below — everyone can do this.

HOW TO WRITE A DOK-3 QUESTION (supports)

DOK-3 = strategic thinking: the reader must analyze, compare, evaluate, or justify using evidence — and there should be more than one defensible answer (not a fact you can just look up).

Sentence starters: “Why did _____ lead to _____?” • “Which mattered more — _____ or _____ — and why?” • “What is the BEST evidence that _____?” • “Evaluate whether _____.” • “Defend or challenge: _____.”

Frame: [Analyze / Evaluate / Justify] + [something from THIS standard] + “using evidence.”

Quick check: does my question make the reader THINK and use evidence? If yes, it's DOK-3.

NOW WRITE YOUR DOK-3 QUESTION HERE

YOUR ANSWER KEY — one clear, defensible sentence

Activity 7 — Constructed Response (CER) — GC.32 ⌚ ~15 min**BIG-QUESTION ORGANIZER (before you write) — How do citizens shape their government — and what does it ask of them in return?**

Plan your argument here, then use it to write your claim, evidence, and reasoning below.

Plan your argument

Your quick notes (from this standard)

My claim (answer the prompt)**Evidence 1 (a source or fact)****Reasoning (why it proves the claim)****CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (CER) — builds SSP.04 Argumentation**

Claim + Evidence + Reasoning: Was Washington right to warn against political parties, or do parties help citizens participate? Defend your claim using Washington's and Madison's words.

Part**Write here****Claim****Evidence (two specifics)****Reasoning**

Constructed Response — self-grade & supports — GC.32

SELF-GRADE — score your own CER against the rubric below

Reread your response, then circle the level that best fits each part. Being honest here is how you level up.

Level	Claim	Evidence	Reasoning
4 — Strong	Precise, defensible	2+ accurate, specific	Explains HOW evidence proves the claim
3 — Proficient	Clear	2 accurate	Explains the link
2 — Developing	General	1 accurate	Partial link
1 — Beginning	Unclear / missing	Missing / inaccurate	No reasoning

MY SCORE

Claim: ____ / 4 Evidence: ____ / 4 Reasoning: ____ / 4 TOTAL: ____ / 12

SUPPORTS — sentence frames (use if you need them)

Claim: “_____ because _____.”

Evidence: “One example is _____ (from _____). Another is _____.”

Reasoning: “This proves my claim because _____, which shows _____.”

REVISE — make your lowest-scoring part stronger

Pick the part you scored lowest and rewrite it here — better:

Standard GC.33 — The Media & Public Opinion

TN Academic Standard GC.33: Describe the role of the media as a means of communicating information and how it influences the importance of issues and public opinion. (T)

LEARNING TARGETS — I can...

- I can describe the role of the media in communicating information and how it shapes which issues seem important and how public opinion forms..

Lenses for this standard: Tennessee (T)

CORE PATH — the same for every student

Every student works this standard at the same rigor: analyze the sources and vocabulary, then show what you learned on the Practice Quiz and the CER. Check yourself against the learning targets on the Cornell Notes page. Supports for each step are on the back of this page.

SET YOUR GOAL (self-direction)

My goal for this standard — what will I be able to do, and how will I show it? (Need help? See the back of this page.)

HOOK — think before you dig in

Two headlines, same event, opposite feeling. Before you form an opinion — who decided what you'd read, and how they'd word it?

ACTIVATE — what do you already know or wonder?

Jot what you already know or want to find out about this standard. You'll come back to it.

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — before you dig in (you'll revisit this at the end)

In your own words: what do you think this standard is about, and why might it matter to you or your community? Write 2-3 sentences.

Getting Started — supports for this page — GC.33

WHAT “CORE PATH” MEANS

Everyone learns the same standard at the same level. “Support options” are just extra ways in — sentence starters, an example, a partner, or recording your answer. They help you reach the bar; they never lower it.

SET YOUR GOAL — how to write a strong one

Example goal: “By the end of this standard I can explain ___ and prove it by scoring 80%+ on the quiz.”

How to build it: name what you’ll DO, then how you’ll PROVE it, then WHEN.

Sentence starters: “I want to be able to...” “I’ll show it by...” “By the end of this standard...”

HOOK — sentence starters

“I think the big question is...” “This connects to...” “I wonder why...” “At first I believe...”

ACTIVATE — what it means & how to answer

What it means: “Activate” = wake up what you ALREADY know before you learn more.

Sentence starters: “I already know...” “This reminds me of...” “I want to find out...”

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — what to write

Just your honest first take — there is no wrong answer. Say what you THINK the standard is about and why it might matter to you, your family, or your community. You’ll come back and improve it at the end.

KEY WORDS TO WATCH FOR

Public Opinion · Media Bias · Public Opinion Poll

NOW TRY IT — draft your goal using a starter above

Write a first draft here, then copy your best version onto the front. Aim for: what you’ll DO + how you’ll PROVE it + WHEN.

Activity 1 — Vocabulary (Part A: Reference / Word Bank) — GC.33 ~10 min

Use this word bank throughout the standard. The Spanish column supports access, not translation of assessment.

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Public Opinion	The collected attitudes and beliefs of a population about issues, leaders, and government, often measured through polls.	opinión pública
Media Bias	A real or perceived slant in how the media selects, frames, or reports information, which can influence how audiences understand an issue.	sesgo mediático
Public Opinion Poll	A survey of a sample of people used to estimate what the larger public thinks; the wording and order of questions can affect the results.	encuesta de opinión pública

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Pronunciations: Public Opinion (PUB-lik uh-PIN-yun); Media Bias (MEE-dee-uh BY-us); Public Opinion Poll (poll).

VOCABULARY SELF-CHECK · Knowledge Rating

Rate each term NOW in pencil, then again at the END — growth is the goal; no penalty for “never seen it.”

Term	1 · never seen it	2 · heard it	3 · can use it	4 · can teach it
Public Opinion				
Media Bias				
Public Opinion Poll				

MAKE IT YOURS (RESPONSE CHOICE): choose ONE term above and show you own it — write a sentence, sketch it, or give a real-world example.

QUICK WRITE

Which of these terms do you think will matter MOST for this standard, and why? You'll revisit this at the end.

Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer-inspired) — GC.33

~7 min

RESPONSE CHOICE — three ways to complete each studio**WRITE:** fill in the four boxes below in your own words.**SAY IT:** explain the term aloud to a partner or your teacher, or record a short voice note — say the term, its meaning, and one example.**DIAGRAM:** sketch or map the term in the Sketch Studio on the back of this page.**PRIORITY TERM 1 Media Bias** · ES: sesgo mediático**Word-bank meaning to build on:** A real or perceived slant in how the media selects, frames, or reports information, which can influence how audiences understand an issue.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Media Bias” to explain this standard.

PRIORITY TERM 2 Public Opinion · ES: opinión pública**Word-bank meaning to build on:** The collected attitudes and beliefs of a population about issues, leaders, and government, often measured through polls.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Public Opinion” to explain this standard.

CONNECT THE TERMS (UDL · build understanding)

How do these priority terms fit together? Write how one leads to or affects another on the lines — or map it in the Sketch Studio on the back.

Activity 2 — Sketch Studio (draw it or say it) — GC.33

SAY IT — pick one way to explain your terms aloud

Explain each priority term to a shoulder partner, then have them explain one back to you.

Or explain a term to your teacher during check-in.

Or record a 20–30 second voice note: say the term, what it means, and one real example.

Or stand and share one term with the class.

DIAGRAM: Media Bias

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

DIAGRAM: Public Opinion

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

CONNECT THE TERMS — concept map

Put both terms in the box and draw arrows to show how one leads to, needs, or affects the other. Write a few words on each arrow.

Activity 3 — Direct Teaching Cornell Notes — GC.33 ⌚ ~20 min

GC.33 — The Media & Public Opinion • Lean Student Deck slides 2–8 • direct-teaching slides 4–6

Your learning targets are on this standard’s opening page — take notes that help you meet them.

Guiding cues	My notes — write your notes here
Key idea of this standard?	
One source that supports it?	
One effect on participation or government?	
Key terms →	

DOODLE ZONE — draw your thinking (UDL · another way in)
Need another way in? Sketch the key idea, a quick timeline, or how the pieces connect. Words optional.

Cornell Notes — keep going, then process & check — GC.33

UDL · CHOOSE HOW YOU CAPTURE IDEAS (same target for everyone)

Keep going with your notes: WRITE on the lines, DRAW or diagram in the box, or do both — your choice. You may also record your notes aloud.

DRAW / DIAGRAM — sketch the idea, a timeline, or how the pieces connect

WRITE — keep taking notes on the lines

Key terms to list

Public Opinion · Media Bias · Public Opinion Poll

Summary — In your own words (2-3 sentences)

PROGRESS CHECK · one question

How can the wording of a public-opinion poll change its results?

- A. Differently worded questions can lead people toward different answers, so wording shapes the result
- B. Wording never affects results because people already have fixed opinions
- C. Polls are always completely accurate regardless of wording
- D. Only the number of people polled matters, never the wording

Commit before you move on — mark it, say it, or explain it aloud.

CHECK YOURSELF — how am I doing?

Which learning targets (on this standard's opening page) can you now meet? Tick the number; circle any you still need help with.

☐ **1**

My 12-15 word headline for this standard

Guided Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.33

These scaffolds support ONLY the Cornell notes — use them to take and process those notes. Optional and easy to set aside; not a separate assignment or a label.

Key vocabulary	What it means
Public Opinion	The collected attitudes and beliefs of a population about issues, leaders, and government, often measured through polls.
Media Bias	A real or perceived slant in how the media selects, frames, or reports information, which can influence how audiences understand an issue.
Public Opinion Poll	A survey of a sample of people used to estimate what the larger public thinks; the wording and order of questions can affect the results.

Break it into steps:

1) Name one cause or effect. 2) Give one piece of evidence. 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of the media & public opinion was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of the media & public opinion was Public Opinion: The collected attitudes and beliefs of a population about issues, leaders, and government, often measured through polls.

GUIDED NOTE REHEARSAL LAB — practice ONE note, step by step

Build one good note here first, then copy it onto your Cornell page. Name the idea → give one piece of evidence → explain the link → write a short headline.

Step	Rehearse it here
Name it	_____ _____
Evidence	_____ _____
Explain	_____ _____
Headline	_____ _____

TRANSFER CHECK — move one rehearsed idea onto the front notes

Light Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.33

A lighter scaffold for the SAME Cornell notes. Try the notes first; reach for this only if you need it.

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Public Opinion	
Media Bias	
Public Opinion Poll	

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below (or in your front notes):

- Why would Jefferson prefer 'newspapers without a government' — what does a free press do for citizens?
- How can the media influence which issues the public thinks are important, even without telling people what to think?
- Give an example of how changing a poll question's wording could change the result.

WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?

Circle the Cornell cue from the front page you still need help with, and tell your teacher so we can go over it.

LIGHT PROCESSING LAB

Answer one guiding question from above in a full sentence, in your own words.

Activity 4 — Close Read — GC.33 ~15 min

Reading type: Government Hack-authored instructional synthesis. This is not a primary source. Builds SSP.03 (synthesize) and SSP.05 (historical awareness).

CORE PATH

A free press is how citizens learn what their government is doing — which is why Thomas Jefferson said that if forced to choose, he would take 'newspapers without a government' over a government without newspapers, and why the First Amendment protects freedom of the press. The media does more than report: by choosing which stories to cover and how to frame them, it influences which issues the public treats as important. Public opinion is measured through polls, but polls are only as reliable as their methods — the wording and order of questions can nudge people toward an answer. 'Media bias' describes a slant in how information is selected or framed. A skilled citizen reads across sources, checks how a poll was worded, and separates evidence from spin.

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Key terms to know first: Public Opinion, Media Bias. Read once for the gist, then again for evidence.

Text-dependent questions (answer in the Evidence Lab below or aloud):

1. Why would Jefferson prefer 'newspapers without a government' — what does a free press do for citizens?
2. How can the media influence which issues the public thinks are important, even without telling people what to think?
3. Give an example of how changing a poll question's wording could change the result.

RESPONSE CHOICE: answer any question by writing in the Evidence Lab, saying/recording it, or diagramming it.

CLOSE-READ EVIDENCE LAB

Log evidence from the passage below.

Question / claim	Exact passage evidence	What the evidence shows

In one sentence — the main idea of this reading:

Spaced Retrieval & Reflection — GC.33

SPACED RETRIEVAL — quick recall (no notes)

Pull it up cold to strengthen memory, then check your notes — retrieval is what makes learning stick.

Recall prompt

Your answer (from memory)

One key term or fact from THIS standard

One thing you learned in an EARLIER standard — how does it connect?

One question you can answer now that you could not before

CHECK YOURSELF — look back and score how it went

Got it right? ☐ Yes ☐ Partly ☐ Not yet **Answer it from memory?** ☐ Yes ☐ With a hint ☐ No

How did it feel? ☐ Confident ☐ Getting there ☐ Shaky — I'll revisit

CONNECT IT — spiral back

How does this standard connect to one you studied earlier, or to something in the world today? Write 2-3 sentences.

WHERE AM I? — plan your next step

Rate your understanding of this standard (1-4): ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

One thing I will review or ask about before the quiz:

Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data Analysis — GC.33 ~15 min

Document (text primary source — analyze with HIPPO). Builds SSP.01–SSP.02.

LETTER TO EDWARD CARRINGTON

“were it left to me to decide whether we should have a government without newspapers, or newspapers without a government, I should not hesitate a moment to prefer the latter.”

Source: Thomas Jefferson, 1787. Founders Online, National Archives. Public domain.
<https://founders.archives.gov/documents/Jefferson/01-11-02-0047>

FIRST LOOK — before you analyze

Jot 3–4 things you notice in the source (details, words, people, dates). No wrong answers.

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
H — Historical context: what was happening when this was created?	
I — Intended audience: who was meant to see or obey it?	
P — Purpose: why was it created?	
P — Point of view: whose perspective does it reflect?	
O — Outside connection: how does it connect to this standard?	

Primary Source Analysis — go deeper — GC.33

SUPPORT OPTION (use if you need it)

Sentence frame: This source shows _____ because it _____, which reveals _____.

SOURCE SYNTHESIS — put it together (SSP.03)

In 2–3 sentences: what does this source reveal about this standard, and how do you know? Cite one specific detail from it.

THINK LIKE A HISTORIAN — corroborate or challenge (SSP.03)

Name ONE other source that could CONFIRM this one, and ONE way it could COMPLICATE or CHALLENGE it — or, whose voice is missing here?

SO WHAT? — why this source still matters today

In 1–2 sentences: why does this source still matter for understanding government today?

CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN

Rate your understanding of this standard (1–4): _____ One thing to revisit:

Activity 6 — Core Application: Practice Quiz — GC.33 ~8 min

RESPONSE CHOICE

Commit to an answer by marking it, saying it, or explaining it aloud before checking. Answer key is in the Teacher Guide (kept separate).

[DOK 1 • item u2-gc33-dok1-1 • pre-field-test]

Which amendment protects freedom of the press?

- A. The First Amendment
- B. The Second Amendment
- C. The Tenth Amendment
- D. The Seventeenth Amendment

[DOK 3 • item u1-gc33-dok3-tc • pre-field-test]

How can the wording of a public-opinion poll change its results?

- A. Differently worded questions can lead people toward different answers, so wording shapes the result
- B. Wording never affects results because people already have fixed opinions
- C. Polls are always completely accurate regardless of wording
- D. Only the number of people polled matters, never the wording

STRETCH — think like a test-writer (open to all)

Write your OWN DOK-3 question for this standard, then a one-sentence answer key. Use the supports below — everyone can do this.

HOW TO WRITE A DOK-3 QUESTION (supports)

DOK-3 = strategic thinking: the reader must analyze, compare, evaluate, or justify using evidence — and there should be more than one defensible answer (not a fact you can just look up).

Sentence starters: “Why did _____ lead to _____?” • “Which mattered more — _____ or _____ — and why?” • “What is the BEST evidence that _____?” • “Evaluate whether _____.” • “Defend or challenge: _____.”

Frame: [Analyze / Evaluate / Justify] + [something from THIS standard] + “using evidence.”

Quick check: does my question make the reader THINK and use evidence? If yes, it's DOK-3.

NOW WRITE YOUR DOK-3 QUESTION HERE

YOUR ANSWER KEY — one clear, defensible sentence

Activity 7 — Constructed Response (CER) — GC.33 ~15 min

BIG-QUESTION ORGANIZER (before you write) — How do citizens shape their government — and what does it ask of them in return?

Plan your argument here, then use it to write your claim, evidence, and reasoning below.

Plan your argument

Your quick notes (from this standard)

My claim (answer the prompt)

Evidence 1 (a source or fact)

Reasoning (why it proves the claim)

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (CER) — builds SSP.04 Argumentation

Claim + Evidence + Reasoning: Does the media mainly report public opinion, or shape it? Defend your claim with evidence, including how poll wording or story framing works.

Part

Write here

Claim

Evidence (two specifics)

Reasoning

Constructed Response — self-grade & supports — GC.33

SELF-GRADE — score your own CER against the rubric below

Reread your response, then circle the level that best fits each part. Being honest here is how you level up.

Level	Claim	Evidence	Reasoning
4 — Strong	Precise, defensible	2+ accurate, specific	Explains HOW evidence proves the claim
3 — Proficient	Clear	2 accurate	Explains the link
2 — Developing	General	1 accurate	Partial link
1 — Beginning	Unclear / missing	Missing / inaccurate	No reasoning

MY SCORE

Claim: ____ / 4 Evidence: ____ / 4 Reasoning: ____ / 4 TOTAL: ____ / 12

SUPPORTS — sentence frames (use if you need them)

Claim: “_____ because _____.”

Evidence: “One example is _____ (from _____). Another is _____.”

Reasoning: “This proves my claim because _____, which shows _____.”

REVISE — make your lowest-scoring part stronger

Pick the part you scored lowest and rewrite it here — better:

Standard GC.34 — Means of Political Participation

TN Academic Standard GC.34: Describe the means that citizens use to participate in the political process, including: campaigning; demonstrating; lobbying; petitioning; running for office; voting. (T)

LEARNING TARGETS — I can...

- I can describe the many ways citizens participate in the political process, from voting and petitioning to campaigning, lobbying, and running for office..

Lenses for this standard: Tennessee (T)

CORE PATH — the same for every student

Every student works this standard at the same rigor: analyze the sources and vocabulary, then show what you learned on the Practice Quiz and the CER. Check yourself against the learning targets on the Cornell Notes page. Supports for each step are on the back of this page.

SET YOUR GOAL (self-direction)

My goal for this standard — what will I be able to do, and how will I show it? (Need help? See the back of this page.)

HOOK — think before you dig in

You don't have to wait for an election to change a law. Name three ways a citizen can act tomorrow — the Constitution protects them.

ACTIVATE — what do you already know or wonder?

Jot what you already know or want to find out about this standard. You'll come back to it.

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — before you dig in (you'll revisit this at the end)

In your own words: what do you think this standard is about, and why might it matter to you or your community? Write 2-3 sentences.

Getting Started — supports for this page — GC.34

WHAT “CORE PATH” MEANS

Everyone learns the same standard at the same level. “Support options” are just extra ways in — sentence starters, an example, a partner, or recording your answer. They help you reach the bar; they never lower it.

SET YOUR GOAL — how to write a strong one

Example goal: “By the end of this standard I can explain ___ and prove it by scoring 80%+ on the quiz.”

How to build it: name what you’ll DO, then how you’ll PROVE it, then WHEN.

Sentence starters: “I want to be able to...” “I’ll show it by...” “By the end of this standard...”

HOOK — sentence starters

“I think the big question is...” “This connects to...” “I wonder why...” “At first I believe...”

ACTIVATE — what it means & how to answer

What it means: “Activate” = wake up what you ALREADY know before you learn more.

Sentence starters: “I already know...” “This reminds me of...” “I want to find out...”

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — what to write

Just your honest first take — there is no wrong answer. Say what you THINK the standard is about and why it might matter to you, your family, or your community. You’ll come back and improve it at the end.

KEY WORDS TO WATCH FOR

Lobbying · Petition · Initiative, Referendum & Recall

NOW TRY IT — draft your goal using a starter above

Write a first draft here, then copy your best version onto the front. Aim for: what you’ll DO + how you’ll PROVE it + WHEN.

Activity 1 — Vocabulary (Part A: Reference / Word Bank) — GC.34 ~10 min

Use this word bank throughout the standard. The Spanish column supports access, not translation of assessment.

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Lobbying	The act of trying to influence the decisions of government officials, usually by individuals or organized interest groups.	cabildeo
Petition	A formal written request signed by many people asking the government to take (or stop) an action — a right protected by the First Amendment.	petición
Initiative, Referendum & Recall	Forms of direct democracy: an initiative lets voters propose a law, a referendum lets them approve or reject one, and a recall lets them remove an official before the term ends.	iniciativa, referéndum y revocatoria

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Pronunciations: Lobbying (LOB-ee-ing); Petition (puh-TISH-un); Initiative, Referendum & Recall (ih-NISH-uh-tiv).

VOCABULARY SELF-CHECK • Knowledge Rating

Rate each term NOW in pencil, then again at the END — growth is the goal; no penalty for “never seen it.”

Term	1 • never seen it	2 • heard it	3 • can use it	4 • can teach it
Lobbying	_____	_____	_____	_____
Petition	_____	_____	_____	_____
Initiative, Referendum & Recall	_____	_____	_____	_____

MAKE IT YOURS (RESPONSE CHOICE): choose ONE term above and show you own it — write a sentence, sketch it, or give a real-world example.

QUICK WRITE

Which of these terms do you think will matter MOST for this standard, and why? You'll revisit this at the end.

Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer-inspired) — GC.34

~7 min

RESPONSE CHOICE — three ways to complete each studio**WRITE:** fill in the four boxes below in your own words.**SAY IT:** explain the term aloud to a partner or your teacher, or record a short voice note — say the term, its meaning, and one example.**DIAGRAM:** sketch or map the term in the Sketch Studio on the back of this page.**PRIORITY TERM 1 Lobbying** · ES: cabildeo**Word-bank meaning to build on:** The act of trying to influence the decisions of government officials, usually by individuals or organized interest groups.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Lobbying” to explain this standard.

PRIORITY TERM 2 Petition · ES: petición**Word-bank meaning to build on:** A formal written request signed by many people asking the government to take (or stop) an action — a right protected by the First Amendment.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Petition” to explain this standard.

CONNECT THE TERMS (UDL · build understanding)

How do these priority terms fit together? Write how one leads to or affects another on the lines — or map it in the Sketch Studio on the back.

Activity 2 — Sketch Studio (draw it or say it) — GC.34

SAY IT — pick one way to explain your terms aloud

Explain each priority term to a shoulder partner, then have them explain one back to you.

Or explain a term to your teacher during check-in.

Or record a 20–30 second voice note: say the term, what it means, and one real example.

Or stand and share one term with the class.

DIAGRAM: Lobbying

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

DIAGRAM: Petition

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

CONNECT THE TERMS — concept map

Put both terms in the box and draw arrows to show how one leads to, needs, or affects the other. Write a few words on each arrow.

Activity 3 — Direct Teaching Cornell Notes — GC.34 ⌚ ~20 min

GC.34 — Means of Political Participation • Lean Student Deck slides 2-8 • direct-teaching slides 4-6

Your learning targets are on this standard’s opening page — take notes that help you meet them.

Guiding cues	My notes — write your notes here
Key idea of this standard?	
One source that supports it?	
One effect on participation or government?	
Key terms →	

DOODLE ZONE — draw your thinking (UDL · another way in)
Need another way in? Sketch the key idea, a quick timeline, or how the pieces connect. Words optional.

Cornell Notes — keep going, then process & check — GC.34

UDL · CHOOSE HOW YOU CAPTURE IDEAS (same target for everyone)

Keep going with your notes: WRITE on the lines, DRAW or diagram in the box, or do both — your choice. You may also record your notes aloud.

DRAW / DIAGRAM — sketch the idea, a timeline, or how the pieces connect

WRITE — keep taking notes on the lines

Key terms to list

Lobbying · Petition · Initiative, Referendum & Recall

Summary — In your own words (2-3 sentences)

PROGRESS CHECK · one question

Which First Amendment right most directly protects a citizen's ability to sign a petition and march in a protest?

- A. The right to bear arms
- B. The right to a speedy trial
- C. The right against unreasonable searches
- D. The right to assemble and to petition the government

Commit before you move on — mark it, say it, or explain it aloud.

CHECK YOURSELF — how am I doing?

Which learning targets (on this standard's opening page) can you now meet? Tick the number; circle any you still need help with.

☐ **1**

My 12-15 word headline for this standard

Guided Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.34

These scaffolds support ONLY the Cornell notes — use them to take and process those notes. Optional and easy to set aside; not a separate assignment or a label.

Key vocabulary	What it means
Lobbying	The act of trying to influence the decisions of government officials, usually by individuals or organized interest groups.
Petition	A formal written request signed by many people asking the government to take (or stop) an action — a right protected by the First Amendment.
Initiative, Referendum & Recall	Forms of direct democracy: an initiative lets voters propose a law, a referendum lets them approve or reject one, and a recall lets them remove an official before the term ends.

Break it into steps:

1) Name one cause or effect. 2) Give one piece of evidence. 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of means of political participation was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of means of political participation was Lobbying: The act of trying to influence the decisions of government officials, usually by individuals or organized interest groups.

GUIDED NOTE REHEARSAL LAB — practice ONE note, step by step

Build one good note here first, then copy it onto your Cornell page. Name the idea → give one piece of evidence → explain the link → write a short headline.

Step	Rehearse it here
Name it	_____ _____
Evidence	_____ _____
Explain	_____ _____
Headline	_____ _____

TRANSFER CHECK — move one rehearsed idea onto the front notes

Light Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.34

A lighter scaffold for the SAME Cornell notes. Try the notes first; reach for this only if you need it.

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Lobbying	
Petition	
Initiative, Referendum & Recall	

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below (or in your front notes):

- Which forms of participation does the First Amendment directly protect, and how?
- How do initiative, referendum, and recall give voters power between elections?
- The Declaration says government rests on the people — how does that idea justify protest and petition?

WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?

Circle the Cornell cue from the front page you still need help with, and tell your teacher so we can go over it.

LIGHT PROCESSING LAB

Answer one guiding question from above in a full sentence, in your own words.

Activity 4 — Close Read — GC.34 ~15 min

Reading type: Government Hack-authored instructional synthesis. This is not a primary source. Builds SSP.03 (synthesize) and SSP.05 (historical awareness).

CORE PATH

Voting is the most familiar way citizens take part in government — but it is far from the only one. Citizens campaign for candidates, demonstrate to draw attention to issues, lobby officials to influence decisions, sign petitions, and run for office themselves. The First Amendment protects the right to 'peaceably assemble' and to 'petition the Government,' and the Declaration of Independence grounds participation in the idea that government derives its authority from the people. Some states add tools of direct democracy: the initiative (voters propose a law), the referendum (voters approve or reject one), and the recall (voters remove an official early). Each is a channel through which ordinary people shape what government does — proof that in a republic, participation does not end at the ballot box.

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Key terms to know first: Lobbying, Petition. Read once for the gist, then again for evidence.

Text-dependent questions (answer in the Evidence Lab below or aloud):

1. Which forms of participation does the First Amendment directly protect, and how?
2. How do initiative, referendum, and recall give voters power between elections?
3. The Declaration says government rests on the people — how does that idea justify protest and petition?

RESPONSE CHOICE: answer any question by writing in the Evidence Lab, saying/recording it, or diagramming it.

CLOSE-READ EVIDENCE LAB

Log evidence from the passage below.

Question / claim	Exact passage evidence	What the evidence shows

In one sentence — the main idea of this reading:

Spaced Retrieval & Reflection — GC.34

SPACED RETRIEVAL — quick recall (no notes)

Pull it up cold to strengthen memory, then check your notes — retrieval is what makes learning stick.

Recall prompt

Your answer (from memory)

One key term or fact from THIS standard

One thing you learned in an EARLIER standard — how does it connect?

One question you can answer now that you could not before

CHECK YOURSELF — look back and score how it went

Got it right? ☐ Yes ☐ Partly ☐ Not yet **Answer it from memory?** ☐ Yes ☐ With a hint ☐ No

How did it feel? ☐ Confident ☐ Getting there ☐ Shaky — I'll revisit

CONNECT IT — spiral back

How does this standard connect to one you studied earlier, or to something in the world today? Write 2-3 sentences.

WHERE AM I? — plan your next step

Rate your understanding of this standard (1-4): ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

One thing I will review or ask about before the quiz:

Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data Analysis — GC.34 ⌚ ~15 min

Primary source (photo) — analyze it with HIPPO. Builds SSP.01–SSP.02.



Woman Suffrage Parade, Washington D.C. · LOC (photographer unknown) · 1913

Source: Library of Congress · <https://www.loc.gov/item/2013648100/> Public domain — no known restrictions
<https://www.loc.gov/item/2013648100/>

FIRST LOOK — before you analyze
Jot 3–4 things you notice in the source (details, words, people, dates). No wrong answers.

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
H — Historical context: what was happening when this was created?	
I — Intended audience: who was meant to see or obey it?	
P — Purpose: why was it created?	
P — Point of view: whose perspective does it reflect?	

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
O — Outside connection: how does it connect to this standard?	

Primary Source Analysis — go deeper — GC.34

SUPPORT OPTION (use if you need it)

Sentence frame: This source shows _____ because it _____, which reveals _____.

SOURCE SYNTHESIS — put it together (SSP.03)

In 2–3 sentences: what does this source reveal about this standard, and how do you know? Cite one specific detail from it.

THINK LIKE A HISTORIAN — corroborate or challenge (SSP.03)

Name ONE other source that could CONFIRM this one, and ONE way it could COMPLICATE or CHALLENGE it — or, whose voice is missing here?

SO WHAT? — why this source still matters today

In 1–2 sentences: why does this source still matter for understanding government today?

CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN

Rate your understanding of this standard (1–4): _____ One thing to revisit:

Activity 6 — Core Application: Practice Quiz — GC.34 ~8 min

RESPONSE CHOICE

Commit to an answer by marking it, saying it, or explaining it aloud before checking. Answer key is in the Teacher Guide (kept separate).

[DOK 1 · item u2-gc34-dok1-1 · pre-field-test]

A process that lets voters remove an elected official before the end of their term is called a:

- A. Referendum
- B. Initiative
- C. Recall
- D. Primary

[DOK 2 · item u1-gc34-dok2-tc · pre-field-test]

Which First Amendment right most directly protects a citizen's ability to sign a petition and march in a protest?

- A. The right to bear arms
- B. The right to a speedy trial
- C. The right against unreasonable searches
- D. The right to assemble and to petition the government

STRETCH — think like a test-writer (open to all)

Write your OWN DOK-3 question for this standard, then a one-sentence answer key. Use the supports below — everyone can do this.

HOW TO WRITE A DOK-3 QUESTION (supports)

DOK-3 = strategic thinking: the reader must analyze, compare, evaluate, or justify using evidence — and there should be more than one defensible answer (not a fact you can just look up).

Sentence starters: “Why did _____ lead to _____?” · “Which mattered more — _____ or _____ — and why?” · “What is the BEST evidence that _____?” · “Evaluate whether _____.” · “Defend or challenge: _____.”

Frame: [Analyze / Evaluate / Justify] + [something from THIS standard] + “using evidence.”

Quick check: does my question make the reader THINK and use evidence? If yes, it's DOK-3.

NOW WRITE YOUR DOK-3 QUESTION HERE

YOUR ANSWER KEY — one clear, defensible sentence

Activity 7 — Constructed Response (CER) — GC.34 ⌚ ~15 min**BIG-QUESTION ORGANIZER (before you write) — How do citizens shape their government — and what does it ask of them in return?**

Plan your argument here, then use it to write your claim, evidence, and reasoning below.

Plan your argument

Your quick notes (from this standard)

My claim (answer the prompt)

Evidence 1 (a source or fact)

Reasoning (why it proves the claim)

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (CER) — builds SSP.04 Argumentation

Claim + Evidence + Reasoning: Beyond voting, which means of participation gives ordinary citizens the most power to change government? Defend your claim with evidence from a source.

Part

Write here

Claim

Evidence (two specifics)

Reasoning

Constructed Response — self-grade & supports — GC.34

SELF-GRADE — score your own CER against the rubric below

Reread your response, then circle the level that best fits each part. Being honest here is how you level up.

Level	Claim	Evidence	Reasoning
4 — Strong	Precise, defensible	2+ accurate, specific	Explains HOW evidence proves the claim
3 — Proficient	Clear	2 accurate	Explains the link
2 — Developing	General	1 accurate	Partial link
1 — Beginning	Unclear / missing	Missing / inaccurate	No reasoning

MY SCORE

Claim: ____ / 4 Evidence: ____ / 4 Reasoning: ____ / 4 TOTAL: ____ / 12

SUPPORTS — sentence frames (use if you need them)

Claim: “_____ because _____.”

Evidence: “One example is _____ (from _____). Another is _____.”

Reasoning: “This proves my claim because _____, which shows _____.”

REVISE — make your lowest-scoring part stronger

Pick the part you scored lowest and rewrite it here — better:

Your Tennessee Connection

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

Tennessee cast the deciding vote for women's suffrage. In August 1920 it became the 36th and final state needed to ratify the 19th Amendment — the 'Perfect 36' — when 24-year-old legislator Harry Burn changed his vote after a note from his mother, extending the vote to women nationwide (GC.34, GC.31).

Reflect (RESPONSE CHOICE): How does a Tennessee connection change the way you understand a national idea? Answer by writing, recording, or diagramming.

Tennessee Civics Investigation

Participation in Tennessee has expanded over time. Investigate one way a Tennessean can take part in government today — registering to vote, serving on a jury, attending a council meeting, or contacting a representative — and record the exact requirement or step.

Prompt	Your findings
A Tennessee example	

Prompt	Your findings
connected to this unit	
One source I could check (library, TN Secretary of State, TSLA, a representative's office)	
How it connects to a standard in this unit	
One question I still have	

Progress Tracker & Cumulative Review

Track your Progress Check result for each standard and note one thing to revisit.

Standard	Progress Check (✓ / reteach)	One thing to revisit
GC.31		
GC.32		
GC.33		
GC.34		

Optional Extension Bank (higher-DOK, open to all)

Any student may choose an extension. These are EXTENSION, not a track.

GC.31: Which citizen responsibility matters most for the well-being of the nation — voting, staying informed, or jury service? Defend your claim with evidence from a source.

GC.32: Was Washington right to warn against political parties, or do parties help citizens participate? Defend your claim using Washington's and Madison's words.

GC.33: Does the media mainly report public opinion, or shape it? Defend your claim with evidence, including how poll wording or story framing works.

GC.34: Beyond voting, which means of participation gives ordinary citizens the most power to change government? Defend your claim with evidence from a source.

Reusable Toolkit & Source Library

Written Response Rubric (CER)

Level	Claim	Evidence	Reasoning
4 — Strong	Precise, defensible	2+ accurate, specific	Explains how evidence proves the claim

Level	Claim	Evidence	Reasoning
3 — Proficient	Clear	2 accurate	Explains the link
2 — Developing	General	1 accurate	Partial link
1 — Beginning	Unclear/missing	Missing/inaccurate	No reasoning

Source Library — full citations & clickable links

GC.31 — The Responsibilities of Citizens

Letter to Richard Price. Thomas Jefferson, 1789. Founders Online, National Archives. Public domain. <https://founders.archives.gov/documents/Jefferson/01-14-02-0196>

U.S. Constitution, Amendment VI. 1st U.S. Congress, 1791. U.S. National Archives. Public domain. <https://www.archives.gov/founding-docs/bill-of-rights-transcript>

GC.32 — Political Parties & the Nomination Process

Farewell Address. George Washington, 1796. The Avalon Project, Yale Law School. Public domain. https://avalon.law.yale.edu/18th_century/washing.asp

Federalist No. 10. James Madison (Publius), 1787. The Avalon Project, Yale Law School. Public domain. https://avalon.law.yale.edu/18th_century/fed10.asp

GC.33 — The Media & Public Opinion

Letter to Edward Carrington. Thomas Jefferson, 1787. Founders Online, National Archives. Public domain. <https://founders.archives.gov/documents/Jefferson/01-11-02-0047>

U.S. Constitution, Amendment I. 1st U.S. Congress, 1791. U.S. National Archives. Public domain. <https://www.archives.gov/founding-docs/bill-of-rights-transcript>

GC.34 — Means of Political Participation

U.S. Constitution, Amendment I. 1st U.S. Congress, 1791. U.S. National Archives. Public domain. <https://www.archives.gov/founding-docs/bill-of-rights-transcript>

Declaration of Independence. Second Continental Congress, 1776. U.S. National Archives. Public domain. <https://www.archives.gov/founding-docs/declaration-transcript>

Whose Participation Counts? Perspectives on Civic Voice

This section complicates the story of participation: who could take part, who was kept out, and who organized to widen the circle. It is Government Hack-authored instructional synthesis grounded in this unit's sourced record — not a primary source.

The Expanding Franchise

Voting was first limited mostly to white male property owners; the 15th, 19th, 24th, and 26th Amendments and the Voting Rights Act widened it over time (connects to GC.34, GC.31).

Political Parties

Parties organize voters and run the nomination process through caucuses and primaries — a system Washington warned against yet one that structures modern participation (GC.32).

The Media & Public Opinion

A free press informs citizens and shapes which issues seem to matter; poll wording and media framing can move opinion as much as report it (GC.33).

The Non-Voter

Millions eligible to vote do not; low turnout raises the question of whose interests get represented when participation is unequal (GC.31, GC.33).

Unit Reflection

Return to the unit's big question: How do citizens shape their government — and what does it ask of them in return? Write a final claim with two pieces of evidence from different standards.

Part	Write here
My claim	
Evidence 1 (standard: __)	
Evidence 2 (standard: __)	
Why it matters today	